



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

tato dhyātvā devagurur jñātvā tasyā viceṣṭitam | BRP131.013.1

satyaṃ śakra tv iyaṃ duṣṭā ripūṇāṃ pakṣakāriṇī || 13 || BRP131.013.2

tataḥ śasāpa tāṃ śakraḥ pāpiṣṭhe tvaṃ śunī bhava | BRP131.014.1

martyaloke pāpabhūtā ajñānāt pāpakāriṇī || 14 || BRP131.014.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 131: Saramā and the Paṇis (Chapter 131), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Brahmapurāṇa recounts a pivotal moment involving Saramā, the divine hound, and Indra, the king of gods. It reveals the consequences of misplaced loyalty and the swiftness of divine justice. The story begins with Brihaspati, the preceptor of the gods, discerning Saramā's actions through his divine insight. He realizes that Saramā, despite her association with the gods, has become sympathetic to the Paṇis, the adversaries of Indra. This betrayal, this leaning towards the "ripūṇāṃ pakṣakāriṇī" – the side of the enemies – is deemed unacceptable.

Indra, upon learning this truth, immediately curses Saramā. He condemns her to become a female dog, "śunī bhava," and to be born into the mortal realm, "martyaloke." The rationale behind this harsh punishment lies in her sin of ignorance, her "ajñānāt pāpakāriṇī," which led her to commit sinful acts. She is deemed "pāpiṣṭhe," the most sinful, for siding with the forces of darkness.

This narrative holds deep significance for your own life. It serves as a potent reminder of the importance of discernment and loyalty. Just as Saramā's lack of wisdom led to her downfall, your choices today can have far-reaching consequences. It highlights the need to be mindful of the company you keep and the ideologies you support. Are you, perhaps unknowingly, aligning yourself with forces that undermine your own spiritual growth or the well-being of others? The story also underscores the concept of divine justice. Actions have consequences, and even seemingly small acts of disloyalty or ignorance can lead to significant repercussions. The swiftness of Indra's curse emphasizes the immediacy with which karma can manifest. In your daily life, this means striving for righteousness, aligning your actions with your values, and remaining vigilant against the allure of negativity. Choose wisely the battles you wage and the allies you embrace.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

In what subtle ways might I be unknowingly supporting forces that contradict my deepest values, and what steps can I take to realign myself with truth and integrity?